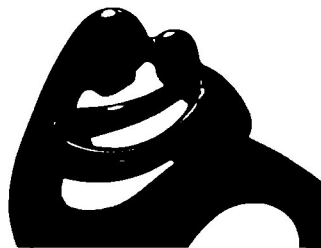


MOTHERLODE

To commemorate Mother's Day, Save the Children has brought out the *State of the World's Mothers* report to highlight where mothers fare best and where they face the greatest hardships



GLOBAL LOSS

350,000

WOMEN DIE DURING PREGNANCY OR CHILD-BIRTH EVERY YEAR.

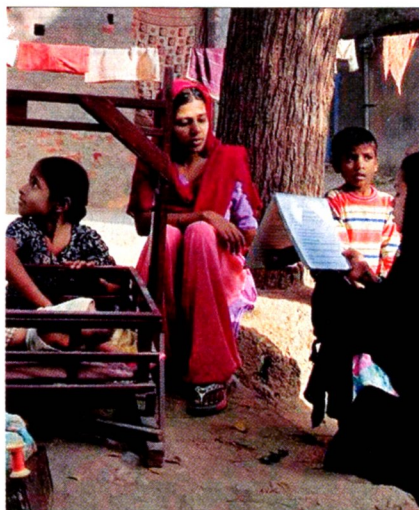
24,000

MOTHERS MOURN THE LOSS OF A CHILD EVERY DAY.



Abysmal America

The US ranks 28th for having one of the highest maternal mortality rates (1 in 4,800) among the wealthy nations: a woman in the US is more than five times as likely as one in Bosnia to die of pregnancy-related causes; the under-five mortality rate is twice of that in Finland, Iceland, Singapore or Sweden; it has the least generous maternity leave policy in the developed world; it also lags behind in women's political status, with only 17 per cent in the House of Representatives compared to 46 in Sweden.



Mothers' Index

Norway tops the list while Afghanistan ranks last in the *Mothers' Index*. India ranks 73 in the list of 77 developing countries. Norway, with the highest ratio of female-to-male earned income, highest contraceptive prevalence rate, one of the lowest under-five mortality rates and one of the most generous maternity leave policies looks after mothers the best. The index was calculated as a weighted average of children's well-being, women's health, educational, economic and political status.

WOMEN'S REPORT CARD

COUNTRY	Risk of death	Births attended by skilled healthworker	Women using modern contraception	Female life expectancy	Expected years of formal schooling	Ratio of estimated female-to-male earned income	Participation of women in national government
 NORWAY	1 in 7,700	All	82%	83 years	18	0.77	40%
 CHINA	1 in 1,300	98%	86	75 years	11	0.68	21%
 BRAZIL	1 in 370	97%	70%	76 years	14	0.60	40%
 INDIA	1 in 70	47%	49%	66 years	10	0.32	11%
 PAKISTAN	1 in 74	39%	22%	67 years	6	0.18	22%



THE LOW MARK

India has the dubious distinction of having the highest number of maternal deaths at 68,000 every year and under-five deaths at 18.3 lakh. Not just that, it also has the greatest shortfall of health workers (doctors, nurses and midwives), estimated to be over 515,000.

■ Compiled by **Damayanti Datta**